

The manuscript titled “The Dynamics of Electrified Vehicle Adoption: An Indian Market Analysis” examines India’s electric and hybrid vehicle market evolution between 2020 and Q1 2025. Using registration data from the Vahan database, it quantifies growth trends, compares fuel-type market shares, and explores regional disparities. The analysis is descriptive and employs Python-based data visualization. In my view, the manuscript could merit favorable consideration following changes based on the below comments.

1/ The manuscript could further contribute by detailing its analytical framework beyond descriptive statistics and plots. Currently, it primarily summarizes trends without employing econometric or inferential methods that substantiate causality or drivers of adoption. The authors are encouraged to enhance analytical robustness by integrating regression or correlation analysis or by validating findings against alternative datasets. If this aspect goes beyond the scope of the current study, the authors are encouraged to briefly explain why it lies outside the present scope and note it as a direction for future research in the manuscript.

2/ The manuscript could further contribute by extending its policy discussion beyond descriptive correlations. While FAME II and PLI are mentioned, there is little quantification of their influence or differentiation among state policy designs. The authors are encouraged to add a comparative policy assessment summarizing which incentives most strongly correlate with higher adoption rates and what this implies for lagging states. The addition would help position the study as a policy-relevant reference for India’s EV transition. If this aspect goes beyond the scope of the current study, the authors are encouraged to briefly explain why it lies outside the present scope and note it as a direction for future research in the manuscript.

3/ The manuscript could further contribute by situating its findings within existing research on EV barriers, drivers, consumer adoption behavior, and policy evaluation, by considering recent literature including but not limited to: (i) Enablers and disablers to plug-in electric vehicle adoption in India: Insights from a survey of experts; (ii) Where there is a will there is a way: A strategy analysis for electric vehicles sales in India. These studies would help contextualize the current analysis within broader insights on the Indian EV transition. The added discussion would help demonstrate that the manuscript builds upon and extends prior work, thereby reinforcing its contribution to the EV literature.

4/ On page 4, the authors state – “The global automotive landscape is undergoing a profound transformation, driven by the imperative to mitigate climate change and reduce reliance on fossil fuels. Electric vehicles (EVs), along with hybrids, collectively termed Electrified Vehicles (xEVs), have emerged as pivotal technologies in this transition, promising cleaner and more sustainable transportation solutions. India, with its burgeoning economy and rapidly expanding urban centres, presents a unique and critical market for xEV adoption. The evolution of xEVs in India, while still developing compared to global leaders, has shown a dramatic acceleration in recent years, reflecting a growing commitment to sustainable mobility.” The authors are recommended to strengthen the contextual setup by highlighting that governments worldwide, including in developing economies such as India and China, are promoting vehicle electrification not only to tackle energy, climate, and environmental challenges, but also to secure strategic advantages in future vehicle manufacturing and industrial competitiveness, by considering recent literature including but not limited to: (i) Net-zero transport dialogue: emerging developments

and the puzzles they present; (ii) Competition and cooperation mechanism of new energy vehicle policies in China's key regions. The added discussion would help position the paper's narrative within the global political economy of electrification, clarifying that India's EV transition is motivated as much by industrial and technological competitiveness as by environmental imperatives.

5/ Highlight the novelty. Reframe objectives as research questions rather than list items.

Discussion: Integrate comparative insights from other developing countries to strengthen external validity.

Conclusion: Summarize implications for policymakers and industry stakeholders; include one or two research extensions.